No. 202

Anson Burlingame Esqr. Department of State
&c. &c. &c. Washington, 20th June 1867

Sir:

This Department is informed by a despatch of the 7th of April last, received from the United States Consul at Hong Kong of the wreck, off the Southern point of the Island of Formosa, of the American ship "Rover" on the 12th of March, 1867, while proceeding from Swatow to Newchwang. The circumstances connected with the loss of this vessel as narrated in the despatch, leave no doubt that the crew, together with the wife of the Master, were cruelly murdered by the savages inhabiting that portion of the island.

You are accordingly instructed 1st to enquire into the facts of the case, - 2nd to report whether the Chinese Government is established or acknowledged in any, or in what degree in the region where this atrocious transaction occurred. If clearly so, then to demand investigation and punishment with such indemnities as are possible. 3rd If no organized government exists there, you will suggest what form of proceeding should be adopted with a view to obtain redress and prevent such transactions in future. 4th You are advised that in no case do the United States desire to seize and hold possession of Formosa or any part of said island.

I am Sir, your obedient servant
William H. Seward

Circular:

(Relative to Diplomatic Uniform)
Department of State.
Washington, 29th March 1867

Ministers and officers of the several grades in the diplomatic service of the United States are hereby instructed to conform to the requirements of the Joint Resolution of Congress approved on the 27th of March instant, prohibiting them from wearing any uniform or official costume not previously authorized by Congress.

The 34th Section of an Act approved on the 28th of July, 1866 authorizes all officers who have served during the rebellion as Volunteers in the armies of the United States